

SALESFORCE DATA QUALITY AUDIT

Week 2 Internship Task

Audit Findings, Recommendations & Data Cleanup Plan

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Data source: Fictional mock records for training
Report date: 9 October 2026

This report does not use real customer or proprietary Salesforce data.

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a simulated data quality audit of 20 fictional Salesforce-style records. The purpose is to demonstrate a repeatable approach to identifying data integrity problems and proposing corrective and preventive controls. The sample intentionally contains duplicate contact information, missing values, an invalid email, inconsistent state naming and incomplete opportunity fields.

The audit framework evaluates completeness, uniqueness, validity, consistency, accuracy and timeliness. Findings suggest that incomplete or inconsistent CRM data can reduce customer contactability, weaken account-level reporting and distort pipeline visibility. The report recommends a controlled cleanup process supported by Salesforce Validation Rules, Matching Rules, Duplicate Rules, restricted picklists, Flow automation and recurring quality dashboards.

2. Objectives

- Define the audit scope and data quality dimensions.
- Review a fictional dataset for common CRM data issues.
- Classify findings by priority and likely business impact.
- Propose a practical cleanup plan with owners and target timing.
- Recommend automation and governance controls to prevent recurrence.

3. Scope

The simulated audit covers contact records and fields commonly associated with accounts and opportunities: contact name, email, phone, account relationship, state, opportunity value and close date. The workbook contains 20 mock rows. Because the rows are training examples, results demonstrate the method rather than the quality of any live Salesforce org.

4. Methodology

1. Define the record scope and quality dimensions.
2. Create fictional records with realistic examples of common issues.
3. Inspect fields against the audit checklist.
4. Flag missing, duplicated, invalid or inconsistent values.
5. Count affected records and classify risk.
6. Recommend corrections and preventive controls.
7. Re-run the same checks after cleanup and document exceptions.

5. Audit Framework

The framework uses commonly accepted data quality dimensions: completeness (required values exist), uniqueness (records are not duplicated), validity (values follow format and business rules), consistency (the same concept uses the same representation), accuracy (values reflect verified reality) and timeliness (records remain current). These are practical audit principles, not a claim of formal certification against a particular standard.

Dimension	Example check	Preventive control
Completeness	Email, account, close date and amount are populated where required	Required fields, Flow reminders
Uniqueness	Same person appears more than once	Matching Rules + Duplicate Rules
Validity	Email uses a valid format	Validation Rule
Consistency	State names use approved values	Restricted Picklist
Accuracy	Opportunity values are verified by owner	Business review / approval
Timeliness	Stale records are identified	Scheduled Flow / dashboard

6. Audit Results

Review of the 20-row mock dataset identified the issues below. Counts represent affected rows or the duplicate pair as described, and issue categories can overlap in the same record. They should not be added together to estimate unique affected records.

Issue	Finding in sample	Priority	Potential impact
Possible duplicate contacts	1 suspected duplicate pair (C003/C015)	High	Duplicate activities and unreliable counts
Missing email	2 records	High	Customer follow-up may fail
Invalid email format	1 record	Medium	Email delivery failure
Missing phone	2 records	Medium	Reduced contact options
Missing account	2 records	High	Weak account-level reporting
Inconsistent state	3 records use abbreviations	Medium	Geographic reports split categories
Missing close date	2 records	High	Pipeline forecasting risk
Missing opportunity value	1 record	High	Pipeline totals may be understated

7. Findings and Business Impact

Duplicate contacts may cause users to contact the same person twice and can inflate activity or customer counts. Missing email and phone values reduce the ability to communicate. Missing account links make it harder to understand customer history and aggregate sales activity. State abbreviations such as “AP” and “KA” may split regional reports from full names. Missing close dates or opportunity values make pipeline dashboards less reliable.

High-priority findings should be addressed first, but no record should be changed without verification. A blank value should not be filled with a guess simply to make a completeness metric look better.

8. Step-by-Step Cleanup Plan

Step 1 — Export or back up the affected records and preserve a copy of the original data.

Step 2 — Identify likely duplicates using email, phone and name; verify the person before merging.

Step 3 — Merge confirmed duplicates under the organisation’s retention rules, preserving useful information and activity history.

Step 4 — Obtain missing email, phone and account values from an approved source or responsible record owner.

Step 5 — Correct invalid email formats and verify values where practical.

Step 6 — Standardize state values to the approved vocabulary, such as “Andhra Pradesh” instead of “AP”.

Step 7 — Ask opportunity owners to confirm missing close dates and amounts.

Step 8 — Re-run the checklist, compare before/after results, record exceptions and obtain sign-off.

9. Salesforce Automation Recommendations

- Validation Rules: block invalid email formats and require close date/amount when an opportunity reaches a defined stage.
- Matching Rules: detect likely duplicates using email, phone and name.
- Duplicate Rules: alert users or block likely duplicate creation according to business policy.
- Restricted Picklists: reduce variations in state/country values.
- Record-triggered Flow: prompt users to complete required details or route exceptions to an owner.
- Scheduled Flow: flag stale records for review; do not auto-fill unverified facts.
- Reports and Dashboards: monitor completeness, duplicates, invalid formats and aging exceptions.
- Data governance: assign data owners, review frequency, escalation and merge approval rules.

10. Cleanup Plan Summary

Priority 1: suspected duplicates, missing account relationships, missing email and missing opportunity data. Priority 2: invalid email format, missing phone and state standardization. Suggested ownership: Salesforce Administrator for configuration, Data Steward for record corrections, Sales Operations for account mapping, and Opportunity Owners for pipeline details. Timing in the workbook is illustrative and should be adjusted to the internship/project scope.

11. Re-Audit and Success Measures

After corrections, repeat the same checks. Suggested targets are zero confirmed duplicate records, valid email formats for all populated email fields, approved state values, and complete required opportunity fields. Track both the number of exceptions and the percentage of records passing each check. Document exceptions that cannot be resolved and assign an owner and due date.

12. Limitations

This is a simulated audit using a small mock dataset, not a connection to a live Salesforce org. Accuracy cannot be fully confirmed without an authoritative source, and an apparent duplicate must be verified before merging. The counts are illustrative and should not be presented as actual Salesforce production metrics.

13. Conclusion

Good Salesforce data quality depends on both correction and prevention. A structured audit, clear ownership and appropriate automation can improve trust in CRM data and support more reliable sales operations. The accompanying Excel workbook provides the mock records, checklist and cleanup plan used for this report.